YOUR CREATIVE STRATEGY PROFILE

C+

LEVEL 2 OF 4

The Student.

You've got taste. You know what good looks like. Now you need to close the gap between watching and doing.

WRITER STUDENT PRACTITIONER STRATEGIST

SCORE BREAKDOWN

01

Here's what your answers told us.

We scored you across 5 areas that matter for creative strategy work. Some are further along than others.

Research	2/4
Data Analysis	1/4
Creative Briefing	2/4
Hypothesis Thinking	1/4
Iteration	2/4

2	3	0
NEED WORK	GETTING THERE	LOCKED IN

WHERE YOU ARE

02

You know a lot. You use almost none of it.

Your answers told us you're paying attention. You mentioned research. You brought up the audience. That's more than most copywriters do. But right now, it's surface-level. You know VOC matters, but you couldn't walk us through how you do it. You know hooks matter, but you couldn't look at data and tell us why one flopped.

REAL TALK

Feeling stuck isn't a personality thing. It means you've been reading about the work instead of doing it. You don't need another thread or framework. You need reps.

What's getting in the way

- **You research, kind of.** You know it matters but you wing it every time. You might peek at competitors, but there's no system you run through before you write.
- **You talk the talk.** You can drop the right words in a meeting, but you can't turn them into actual deliverables. Knowing what VOC means and doing the work to mine it? Two different planets.
- **Your briefs are dressed-up scripts.** When someone asks for a brief, you hand them a creative script wearing a strategy costume. The bones of a real brief aren't there yet.
- **Data makes your eyes glaze over.** You see the numbers. You nod. But you can't connect them to what should happen next. The muscle to read data and act on it hasn't been built.
- **You bookmark everything and use nothing.** You follow the right people. You save the right posts. Your "read later" folder is enormous. But none of it has changed how you work.

WHAT THIS MEANS

03

Knowing about strategy doesn't make you a strategist.

You're ahead of the Writer because you see the bigger picture. But seeing it and working inside it are different things. Until what you know turns into how you work, you're still getting hired for output alone.

WHAT YOU DO NOW	WHAT THE NEXT LEVEL DOES
"I should probably do research"	**Pull Amazon reviews, Reddit threads, competitor ads. Organize by theme. Do it every time.**
Know what hooks, angles, and CTR mean	**Write a hypothesis, test an angle, read a metric and know what it's telling you**
Screenshot frameworks from Twitter	**Use those frameworks on real client work this week**
Bookmark posts about reading data	**Open a dashboard and explain why hook rate is up but conversions are down**
Start over when something flops	**Figure out if it was the hook, the angle, or the offer before touching anything**

You don't have an information problem. You have a reps problem. You've collected enough. The next level is about doing the work, not reading about it.

Five skills that change everything.

These are the things that separate people who write from people who think. Here's where you stand on each one.

Emerging

1. Research

You know it matters. You might Google competitors before a project. But you don't have a go-to process for pulling real customer language and organizing it. It's ad hoc, not a system.

Not started

2. Data Analysis

This is about looking at CTR, CPA, CVR, and hook rate and understanding the story they tell. Not "the ad didn't work" but "the hook pulled in curious people who never planned to buy, so CTR was great and conversions tanked." You see the numbers. You don't see the story yet.

Emerging

3. Creative Briefing

You have a rough idea of what goes in a brief. But when you write one, it reads like a script that borrowed some strategy words. No hypothesis. No test variable. No real structure holding it together.

Not started

4. Hypothesis Thinking

This means having a testable belief before you create anything. "I think this angle will land with this group because I found this in my research." Every ad is an experiment. If you don't know what you're testing, the results teach you nothing. You're not doing this yet.

Emerging

5. Iteration

Your gut tells you when something feels off. But you can't name what's wrong or fix it with any consistency. Was it the hook? The angle? The audience? Right now you're guessing, not diagnosing.

LEVEL UP

05

How you get to The Practitioner.

The gap between Student and Practitioner comes down to reps. Stop reading about research and go do it. Stop saving frameworks and use one on a real project this week.

PROGRESS TO NEXT LEVEL

The Practitioner (B)

2 skills to go

The Student (C+) — The Practitioner (B)

01

Do real research once

Pick one project. Spend 30 minutes pulling Amazon reviews, Reddit threads, competitor ads. Sort what you find into: love, hate, fear. Then write. Do it three times this week.

+ Builds a research process you can repeat

02

Write a hypothesis before you write anything

Before your next piece of copy, write one sentence: "I think this angle will work for this audience because of this insight." If you can't fill it in, you need more research.

+ Turns guessing into testing

03

Read one set of real numbers

Find a published ad performance case study. Look at CTR, CPA, hook rate. Practice asking "why" for each number. What happened? What does it mean?

+ Builds the data reading muscle

You took the quiz.
And you're still reading.

That tells me something. Most people skim the grade and close the tab. You made it to the last page. That matters more than any score.

Tomorrow, you'll get the first of a daily email from me. Each one picks up where this report left off. A thing to try, a way to think, something you can use on whatever you're working on right now. They're short. They're built for people who do the work.

- **Week 1:** Research reps. Pick a project, spend 30 minutes mining real customer language, organize what you find. Do it three times.
- **Week 2:** Hypothesis practice. Write one sentence about what you think will work and why before you write a single line of copy.
- **Week 3:** Data reading. One case study a day. Look at the numbers and practice asking "what happened here?"
- **Week 4:** Brief building. Take a real project and write a brief with teeth: insight, hypothesis, hook direction, test variable.

ONE THING BEFORE YOU GO

Reply to tomorrow's email with the word STUDENT and tell me what kind of work you're doing right now. Freelance? In-house? Agency? What are you writing? I read every reply.